MISSION ARCHITECT TOOLKIT / SESSION 606

DEBRIEF + LEARNING TRANSFER GUIDE

Turn game experiences into meaningful learning.

After learners play, help participants reflect on the decisions they made, explain their reasoning, and connect the experience to real-world skills. Consider a follow-up learning check to see if they can apply those skills.

A FIVE-MINUTE DEBRIEF

30 SEC RECALL / 2 MIN EXAMINE / 2 MIN APPLY / 30 SEC WRAP

Ask about the decision, not just the solution. Invite explanations, then connect the reasoning to another situation.

01 RECALL	**What happened?** "What did your team attempt? What new information changed your plan?"	**FACILITATOR MOVE** Invite a concise account; avoid a full clue-by-clue walkthrough.
02 EXAMINE	**Why did you decide that?** "Which evidence or constraint mattered most? What alternatives did you reject?"	**FACILITATOR MOVE** Probe the reasoning. Ask how they checked the result.
03 APPLY	**Where else would this work?** "Where might you make a similar decision? What would you need to know?"	**FACILITATOR MOVE** Connect to the real task and its limits; avoid a generic "teamwork" takeaway.

QUICK PROMPTS FROM THE BACKUP LEAGUE

MEMORY MELTDOWN

What made an incident genuinely consequential? Why did those three reports belong in that order?

GADGET GRAVEYARD

Which operating constraints ruled out a setting that initially looked workable?

ACADEMY CONFIDENTIAL

What evidence supported holding and verifying before deploying cadets?

IF A TEAM DID NOT FINISH

Reveal the story resolution without treating speed as ability. Ask what they attempted, which evidence they had, and what they would examine next. Unfinished play can still reveal valuable thinking.

IF YOU ONLY HAVE ONE MINUTE

Ask three fast questions: "What was the decision? Which evidence mattered? Where might that reasoning help again?" Capture one answer, then share the intended resolution.

CLOSE WITH THE SKILL "The rescue was the story. The question is how you made and checked decisions."

CHECK WHETHER LEARNING TRANSFERS

Plan evidence of learning without confusing team progress with individual mastery.

THREE LEVELS OF EVIDENCE

01 COMPLETION

What it shows: the team progressed through the game.

Check: final code, chapter result, or time to finish.

Not evidence of individual mastery.

02 REASONING

What it shows: someone can explain the choice using supplied criteria.

Check: ask each learner to justify the answer and reject an alternative.

Better evidence of understanding.

03 TRANSFER

What it shows: someone can apply the same decision process to a fresh case.

Check: assign a comparable scenario and score the response independently.

Stronger evidence of application.

PLAN AN (OPTIONAL) FOLLOW-UP LEARNING CHECK

After the debrief, consider giving each participant a short, unfamiliar scenario that requires the same reasoning to see if they can apply the new skill(s). Some questions to think through when planning the new interaction:

SKILL TO REUSE	What decision or action did the game help participants practice?
NEW SITUATION	What different scenario would require the same skill without allowing participants to repeat the memorized answer?
EVIDENCE OF LEARNING	What correct decision and explanation would demonstrate that someone understands the skill?
CHECK RESULTS	How and when will learners demonstrate the skill independently?

BACKUP LEAGUE EXAMPLE

Instead of HQ incident reports, give each learner six fictional maintenance requests with different safety consequences and timelines. Using a supplied, validated priority guide, ask them to select and rank the top three and explain the deciding evidence.

EVIDENCE OF LEARNING

☐ Decisions used the supplied criteria ☐ Learners explained their reasoning ☐ New-case performance checked

One thing to revise next time: _____

REMEMBER A correct final answer is satisfying feedback. It is not, by itself, a measure of individual performance.